

Google Ads API — Tool Design Document

Softcommunications Inc. (Softcom) | Internal advertising-operations tool

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1. Overview and Purpose

Softcommunications Inc. is a Japan-based digital marketing agency (SEM / paid advertising operations). We manage Google Ads accounts for our own company and for our clients under our manager (MCC) accounts. This tool is an **internal, semi-automated operations assistant**. It uses the Google Ads API to retrieve performance data, generate reports and analysis, and produce optimization *suggestions*. It does **not** make unattended automated changes: every budget/bid/on-off change is reviewed and approved by a human before it is applied.

The primary goal is to reduce key-person dependency: encode our operational judgment into a shared rulebook so that reporting and analysis are consistent regardless of which staff member runs them. Initial usage is **read-only reporting and analysis**.

2. Users and Access

- **Audience:** Internal users only (employees, including outsourced contractors under NDA). Not distributed to the general public or offered as a third-party SaaS.
- **Accounts:** Softcom's own Google Ads account first (test/evaluation phase), then client accounts managed under our MCC, added one at a time.
- **Developer token:** Issued on and used only within our MCC (640-292-1549).

3. System Architecture and Data Flow

The tool runs a daily loop. All write operations are gated behind human approval:

Step	Action	API access
1. Fetch	Retrieve last-7-day metrics (campaign / ad group / keyword)	Read
2. Analyze	Compare metrics against thresholds in the rulebook (CPA/ROAS, wasted spend, etc.)	Read
3. Draft	Generate change proposals; new entities are drafted as PAUSED	None
4. Approve	Human reviews the queue and approves or rejects each proposal	None
5. Apply	Only approved changes are written back; before/after values are logged	Write (future)

Fetching is via the Google Ads API. Analysis and proposal drafting happen in our own environment. Writes are out of scope for the initial (read-only) phase.

4. Google Ads API Usage

- **Reporting (primary):** GoogleAdsService.SearchStream / Search with GAQL queries against campaign, ad_group, ad_group_ad, keyword_view and related resources to read spend, conversions, conversion value, impressions, clicks, and derived CPA/ROAS/CTR.
- **Metadata:** customer and campaign resources to resolve names, status, and budgets.

- **Mutations (future, approval-gated):** CampaignBudgetService and CampaignService / AdGroupService for budget, bid, and status changes — applied only after human approval, with per-change rate guards (e.g. max +30% budget increase per change).

5. Human-in-the-loop Approval and Change Guards

- No auto-approval. The tool produces drafts only; a person approves before any write.
- New entities are created as PAUSED and explicitly enabled by an approver.
- Budget changes beyond +/-20% require manager approval; full stops require manager approval; large clients require two-step approval.
- Every applied change logs who, when, what, and the before/after values.

6. Security and Compliance

- Secrets (developer token, OAuth client secret, refresh token) are stored only as environment variables / secret manager entries, never in source code, documents, or chat.
- Per-client credential separation; operations are traceable by operator identity.
- OAuth 2.0 (desktop) for authentication; least-privilege access.
- Advertising content follows Google Ads policies and, for medical/cosmetic clients, Japan's medical advertising guidelines; ambiguous expressions are escalated to a human reviewer.

7. Data Handling

Retrieved performance data is used solely for internal reporting, analysis, and proposal generation. Data is not resold or provided to third parties. Client data is kept separated per client and handled under our confidentiality obligations.

8. Roadmap

- Phase 0: Read-only reporting/analysis on Softcom's own account (evaluation).
- Phase 1: Extend read-only coverage to managed client accounts; daily reporting.
- Phase 2: Approval-gated writes (budget/bid/status) with full change logging.

This tool is designed to be a responsible, human-supervised use of the Google Ads API, prioritizing read access and requiring explicit human approval for any change.